

Sprint 1 - TaxonBodyMassML (group #32)

Executive Summary

- Our project partner, Mark Novak, provided us with a pre-made GitHub repo. He included a README and a .gitignore file, as well as a lot of data for our project. We are waiting for a response from our project partner on the type of license he would like to include in the GitHub. For now, we have created a LICENSE.md file which will remain empty until we know what type of license we are working with. The link is:
<https://github.com/marknovak/TaxonBodyMassML>
- Our precedents for communication are explicitly laid out in the table below, which we have pinned in our 'general' channel for easy reference.
- We created a linear project board. It has been populated with 5-10 upcoming tasks and is included below. Our project partner has been given access.
- Our branching policy is that each major feature should have its own branch. To merge, a pull request should be created and should have at least review and pass all tests. Below, we included a screenshot of the pull request template/checklist which is in the .github directory.

Communications Table

	Grant, Hailey, and Anish	Mark	Birat
Primary Communication	Discord	Slack	Discord (ta-communication)
Usage	Voice channels for meetings. Text channels as follows: todo to communicate tasks, resources to share important links or files, status update to share progress reports.	All regular communication.	Voice channels for meetings. Text channels as follows: ta-communication for general messages, and status update to share progress reports.
Meeting Cadence	>= 1 per week	1 per 2 weeks	1 per week
Meeting Time	Thurs 4:30pm	Wed 9:00am	Fri 9:00am
Emergency Communication	Text	Email	Discord DMs
Expected Response Time	Within a few hours (normal work hours) By the next morning (outside normal work hours)	Within 24 hours	Within 24 hours

(pinned in general channel)


Pinned Messages


HaileyCS 9:53 AM

	Grant, Hailey, and Anish	Mark	Birat
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GitHub Repo:

The screenshot shows the GitHub repository page for 'TaxonBodyMassML' by user 'marknovak'. The repository is public and has 0 stars, 0 forks, and 0 watchers. The main branch is 'main'. The repository contains three files: 'data', '.gitignore', and 'README.md'. The 'README.md' file is selected and shows its commit history, with the latest commit being 'Update README' by 'marknovak' 2 months ago. The 'About' section on the right describes the project as 'Phylogeny-informed prediction of species body weight' and provides links to the README, Activity, and Stars.

README:

The screenshot shows the README file for the 'TaxonBodyMassML' repository. The title is 'TaxonBodyMassML - Phylogeny-informed prediction of species body weight'. The 'Project Description' section states that the project will harness a comprehensive database of measured species body masses together with the 'Open Tree of Life' phylogenetic framework to train a large language model to estimate a species' body mass from its scientific name and taxonomy. The 'Motivations' section explains that body mass is a master trait because it scales predictably with nearly every aspect of a species' biology. The 'Objectives/Deliverables' section lists four goals: 1. A fully trained, fine-tuned Python implementation of a large language model that ingests a species name and returns a body-mass estimate, provenance flag, and uncertainty descriptor. 2. A clean, reproducible training pipeline (including data preprocessing, phylogenetic feature engineering, and evaluation metrics) documented in a GitHub repository. 3. A responsive web application (frontend + backend) that accepts single or comma-delimited species lists, queries the model, and displays and exports results with clear provenance and uncertainty. 4. A technical report detailing model architecture, training procedure, validation results, and guidance for future extensions.

Created currently empty LICENSE.md:

Name	Last commit message
 .github/workflows	Added blank github actions script
 data	Add bodymass data from FracFeed_DB
 .gitignore	Initial commit
 LICENSE.md	Create LICENSE.md
 README.md	Update README

Populated Backlog:

All IssuesActiveBacklog

Filter

Backlog 7

TAX-12

Draft API Communication Contract

...

TAX-11

Data Cleaning

...

TAX-10

Research and Decide on Model

...

TAX-9

Initial Analysis of Data

...

TAX-8

Requirements assignment

...

TAX-7

Webapp Shell

...

TAX-6

Initial Project Partner Meeting Notes

...

In Review 1

TAX-5

Set up blank workflow in GitHub

...

Done 4

TAX-3

Connect your tools (3)

...

TAX-2

Set up your teams (2)

...

TAX-4

Import your data (4)

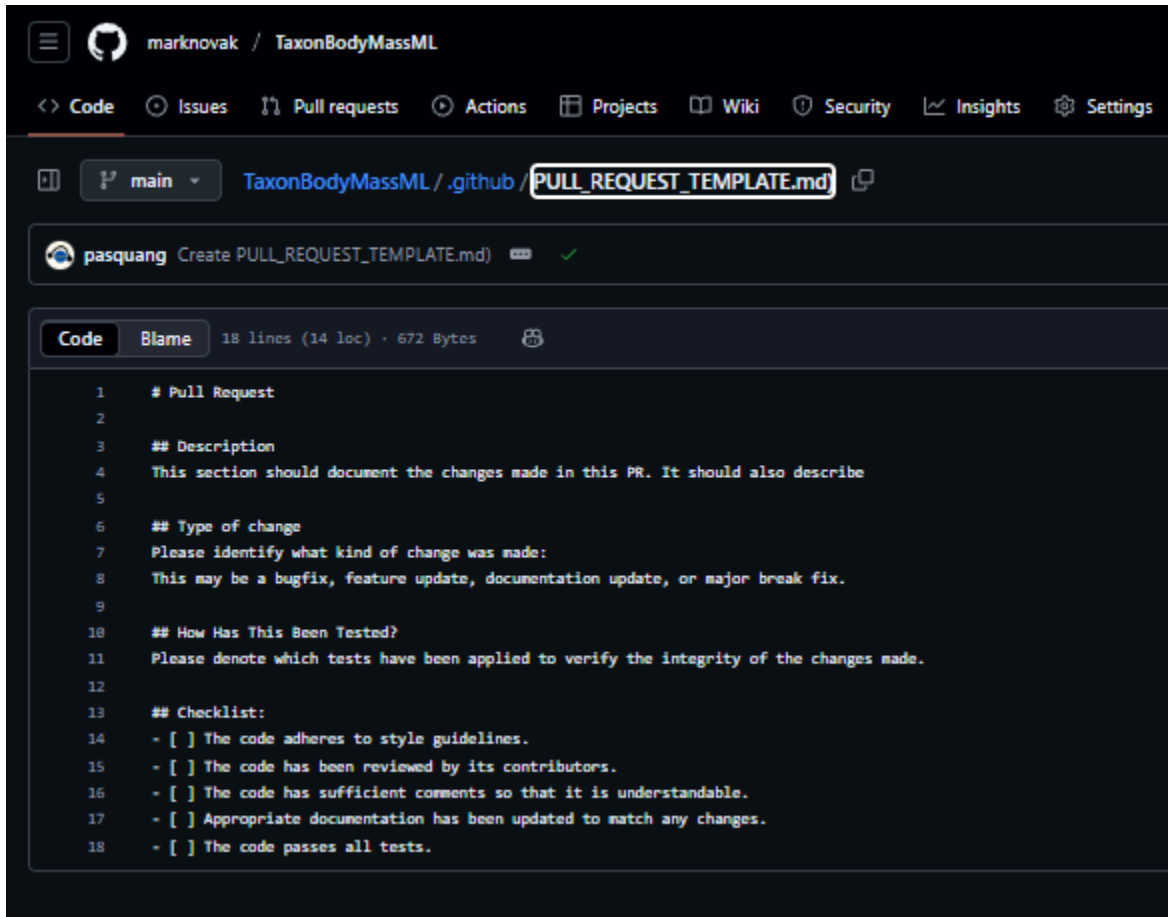
...

TAX-1

Get familiar with Linear (1)

...

PR Template



The screenshot shows a GitHub repository page for 'marknovak / TaxonBodyMassML'. The navigation bar includes links for Code, Issues, Pull requests, Actions, Projects, Wiki, Security, Insights, and Settings. The current view is the 'main' branch, showing the file 'PULL_REQUEST_TEMPLATE.md'. A commit by 'pasquang' is shown with a green checkmark. The file content is a template for a Pull Request, consisting of 18 lines of text. It includes sections for Description, Type of change, How Has This Been Tested?, and a Checklist.

```
1  # Pull Request
2
3  ## Description
4  This section should document the changes made in this PR. It should also describe
5
6  ## Type of change
7  Please identify what kind of change was made:
8  This may be a bugfix, feature update, documentation update, or major break fix.
9
10 ## How Has This Been Tested?
11 Please denote which tests have been applied to verify the integrity of the changes made.
12
13 ## Checklist:
14 - [ ] The code adheres to style guidelines.
15 - [ ] The code has been reviewed by its contributors.
16 - [ ] The code has sufficient comments so that it is understandable.
17 - [ ] Appropriate documentation has been updated to match any changes.
18 - [ ] The code passes all tests.
```